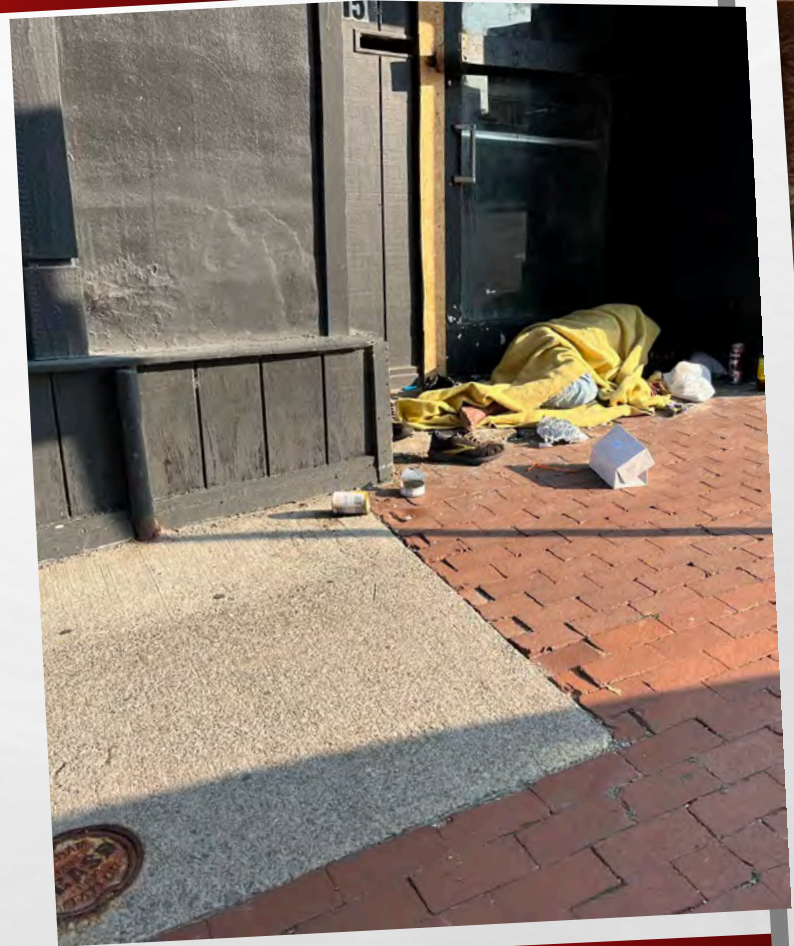




All Photos Are From Rochester, NY, : Courtesy of Stephen Rosa, Senior Outreach and Engagement Specialist, PCHO

Homelessness in Focus: Addressing the Crisis in Rochester and Beyond

HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS: ADDRESSING THE CRISIS IN ROCHESTER AND BEYOND



PRESENTED BY RACHEL S. BAILEY, MUP

- HOMELESS OUTREACH PROGRAM MANAGER-PERSON CENTERED HOUSING OPTIONS, INC (PCHO)
- PROGRAM MANAGER-PCHO TEMPRO EMERGENCY SHELTER HOMES

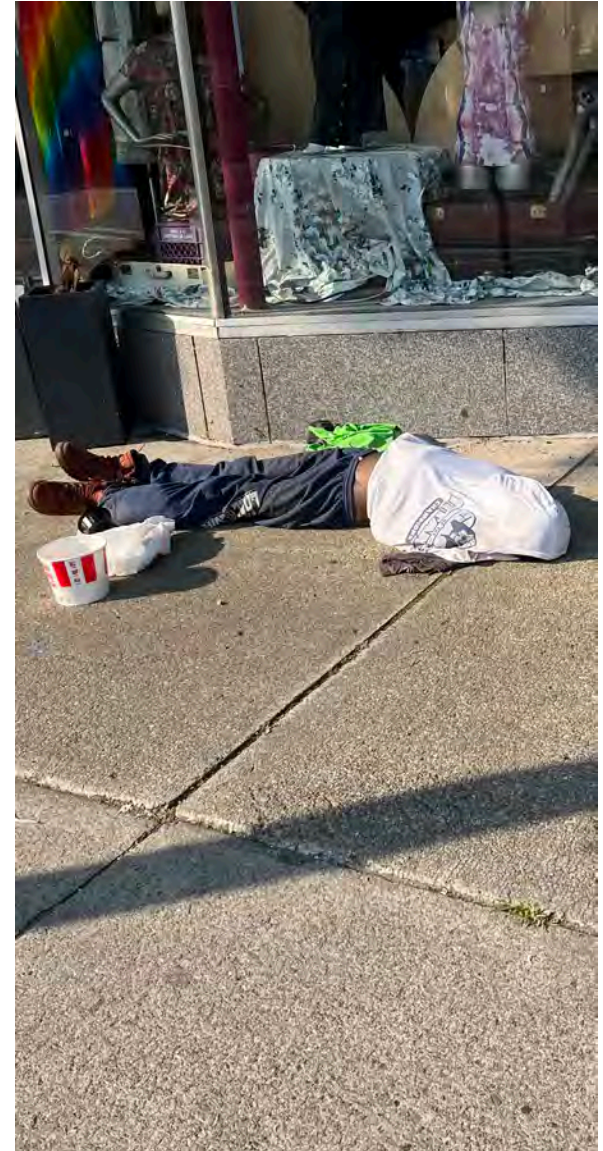
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- ENCAMPMENTS
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- ROCHESTER'S HOMELESS ECOSYSTEM NETWORK
- WHAT CAN PLANNERS AND COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT PROFESSIONALS CAN DO
- WHAT CAN PRIVATE CITIZENS DO
- QUESTION AND ANSWER SESSION WITH THE PANEL

Homelessness in Focus: Addressing the Crisis in Rochester and Beyond

INTRODUCTIONS

Homelessness in Focus: Addressing the
Crisis in Rochester and Beyond



RACHEL S. BAILEY, MUP



Education

MUP-UB

BA-ECO-UR

AAS-ARCH-OCC

Professional Background

Program and Project Management

- Affordable Housing Development
- Community Development
- Youth Entrepreneurship Training
- Corporate Buyer
- Entrepreneur

Lived Experience

High School Drop-out, Teen Runaway, Homeless, Single Parent Experiencing Economic, Housing and Food Insecurity, and a Caretaker

WHY I'M PRESENTING

Create More Awareness

Funding in Jeopardy

**Share the Reality's of the
Street**

Destigmatize the Unhoused

Share Ideas and Solutions

ROCHESTER'S DEDICATED AND PASSIONATE HOMELESS ECOSYSTEM PANEL AND THEIR ROLES

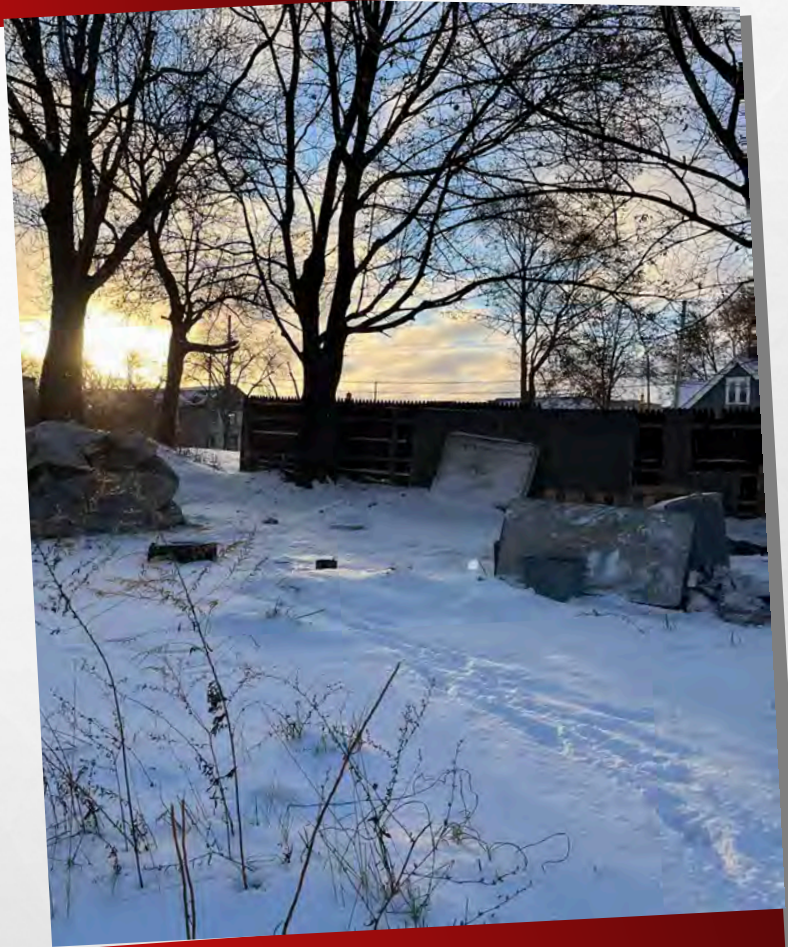
- **NICK COULTER** — FOUNDED PARTNER, VP OF DEVELOPMENT, PERSON CENTERED HOUSING OPTIONS, INC. (PCHO)
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- **PAIGE CASEY** — BS, ADVANCED CASAC, STREET OUTREACH TEAM LEADER, -HELIO HEALTH IN MONROE COUNTY

MY FORMERLY HOMELESS DOG



Yoda

CAUSES OF HOMELESSNESS



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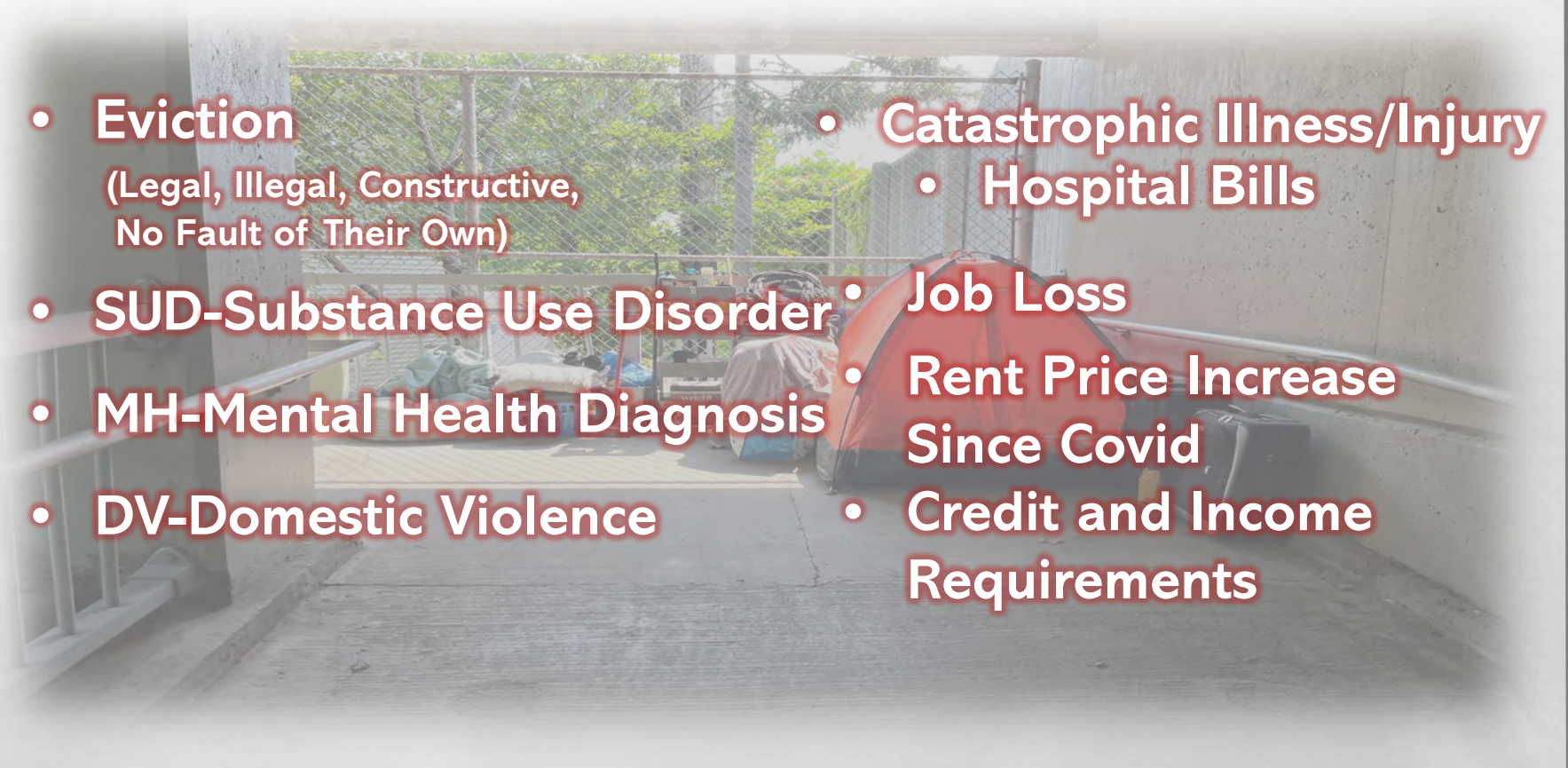


CAUSES OF HOMELESSNESS

HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS:
ADDRESSING THE CRISIS
IN ROCHESTER AND
BEYOND



HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS: ADDRESSING THE CRISIS IN ROCHESTER AND BEYOND

- 
- **Eviction**
(Legal, Illegal, Constructive, No Fault of Their Own)
 - **SUD-Substance Use Disorder**
 - **MH-Mental Health Diagnosis**
 - **DV-Domestic Violence**
 - **Catastrophic Illness/Injury**
 - **Hospital Bills**
 - **Job Loss**
 - **Rent Price Increase Since Covid**
 - **Credit and Income Requirements**

CAUSES OF HOMELESSNESS



Homelessness in Focus: Addressing the Crisis in Rochester and Beyond

Consequences of Being Unhoused



Homelessness in Focus: Addressing the Crisis in Rochester and Beyond

HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS: ADDRESSING THE CRISIS IN ROCHESTER AND BEYOND

CONSEQUENCES OF BEING UNHOUSED

- CRIMINALIZATION (TRESPASS, ARREST, RECORD)
- HIGHER DEATH RATE DUE TO BEING HOMELESS
- TARGETED VIOLENCE
- RAPE
- OVERDOSE
- WOUND INFECTIONS
- TRAUMA/MENTAL HEALTH
- FROST BITE/LOSS OF LIMB
- POOR HEALTH
- POOR DENTAL
- STIGMA



HOMELESS ENCAMPMENTS



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HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS: ADDRESSING THE CRISIS IN ROCHESTER AND BEYOND

HOMELESS ENCAMPMENTS



Safety in Numbers

Including Protection From:

Violence

Overdose

Share Resources

Provides Community



What Constitutes an Encampment And Why Do They Form



HOMELESS ENCAMPMENTS

Why Homeless Encampments are Targeted by Municipalities

HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS: ADDRESSING THE CRISIS IN ROCHESTER AND BEYOND

HOMELESS ENCAMPMENTS



- **Political Optics/Public View**
- **Community Complaints**
- **Business Complaints**
- **Garbage /Needles**
- **Biohazard/ Sanitation**



Why Homeless Encampments are Targeted by Municipalities

HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS: ADDRESSING THE CRISIS IN ROCHESTER AND BEYOND

HOMELESS ENCAMPMENTS



Encampments Don't Have a Legitimate Address So There Are nNo Public Services Like:

Garbage Pickup | Sanitation | Potable Water | Mail



STOP CRIMINALIZING THE UNHOUSED

Challenges/Barriers



Homelessness in Focus: Addressing the Crisis in Rochester and Beyond

Emergency Shelters

There is a Shortage of Emergency Shelter Beds and When There is Room:

- **Not Everyone *Wants* to go to a Homeless Shelter**
 - Previous Bad Experience
 - Mental Health Triggers
 - Fear of Withdrawals
- **Not Everyone *Can* go to a Homeless Shelter**
 - DHS Sanctions
 - Severe Mental Health
 - Physical Disabilities/Mobility/Incontinence
 - Developmental Disabilities

Challenges/Barriers



Housing

- **Shortage of Affordable Housing**
- **Exponential Increase In Rent Since Covid**
- **Stricter Qualification Requirements to be Considered a Rental Candidate**
 - 3x Income/Rent, 600+ Credit, Good Rental History w/ no Evictions
 - Discrimination (Some Landlords Circumvent the Laws)

Challenges/Barriers

FUNDING IN JEOPARDY

HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS:
ADDRESSING THE CRISIS IN
ROCHESTER AND BEYOND



Solutions



Homelessness in Focus: Addressing the Crisis in Rochester and Beyond

NEEDS/SOLUTIONS

- MORE EMERGENCY SHELTER BEDS
- MORE EMERGENCY SHELTER BEDS WITH LOWER BARRIERS
- ADAPTIVE REUSE OF VACANT BUILDINGS INCLUDING:
 - ABANDONED BUILDINGS
 - FORECLOSED HOUSES
 - FORECLOSED/VACANT MOTELS
- DESIGNATED, SANCTIONED, SAFE ENCAMPMENTS (WITH SERVICES)
 - SET ASIDE LAND AT COUNTY/CITY/STATE PARKS)
- CAR/RV OVERNIGHT LOTS
- TINY HOUSES/VILLAGES
- SHIPPING CONTAINERS
- PALLET SHELTERS

STOP CRIMINALIZING THE UNHOUSED

SOLUTIONS/BEST PRACTICES AROUND THE COUNTRY

Acquiring Motels

CALIFORNIA

Homekey is the fastest, largest, and most cost-effective addition of interim and permanent housing in California history. Initially launched to protect vulnerable residents from COVID-19 at the start of the pandemic, Homekey makes grant funding from the state Department of Housing and Community Development available to cities, counties, housing authorities, tribal entities, and other local public entities to acquire and then convert hotels, motels, multi-family apartments, and more, into permanent or interim housing.

To date, Los Angeles County has used Homekey to acquire 32 properties (2,157 units), mostly hotels and motels, to convert into interim and permanent housing for people experiencing homelessness.

Homekey



SOLUTIONS/BEST PRACTICES AROUND THE COUNTRY

Sanctioned Outdoor Spaces

Safe outdoor spaces reduce unsanctioned camping and the problems that come with it, by creating a safe, clean space for people experiencing homelessness for whom conventional shelters are not an option. Safe Outdoor Spaces typically are made up of several sturdy tents and community space within a fenced-in, controlled area. Individuals find food, shelter, safety, healthcare, compassion, and equity through wrap-around services as a stepping-stone for more permanent housing.

Tents for Safe Camping

Seattle, Washington

Permitted Villages

Has “permitted villages” (city-nonprofit partnerships) that are regulated, with support services and somewhat more tolerance under certain conditions.

The permitted villages are an example of sanctioned / tolerated encampments, giving people a legal place to stay with services.

Permitted Villages

**Stop
Encampment
Sweeps**

**Stop
Criminalizing
The Homeless**

**Stop
Criminalizing
Panhandling**

**Advocate For
Local, State,
and National
Reform**

POLICY NEEDS

Homelessness in Focus: Addressing the Crisis in Rochester and Beyond



ROCHESTER'S HOMELESSNESS ★ ECOSYSTEM NETWORK



Person Centered Housing Options

NICK COULTER

Co-Founder, Executive Vice President and Chief of
Development



Person Centered Housing Options

Why Was PCHO Created?

**What Is PCHO'S Role In Solving Rochester's
Homelessness Crisis?**

**How Has PCHO Made A Difference To The
Unhoused**

HOUSING FIRST



HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS: ADDRESSING THE CRISIS IN
ROCHESTER AND BEYOND



System Flow by Last Exit

Hover or touch here for visualization information



88% Left The
Street

431

Street Outreach

578

Housed

\$4700

93% Stay In Housing



Person Centered Housing Options

STEPHEN ROSA

AAS, CRPA, LIVED EXPERIENCE

**SENIOR OUTREACH AND ENGAGEMENT SPECIALIST
RECOVERY ALL WAYS (RAW)**





Person Centered Housing Options



**McQuaid Students
Shadowing With
PCHO's Outreach
Team.**

**Stephen Explains The
History Of The
Encampment And The
Stories Of The
Residents Who Live
Under This Bridge**



Person Centered Housing Options

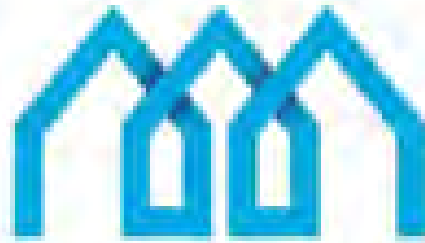
What Role Does PCHO's Outreach Department Play in Getting People Off The Street, And Into Housing?

Meet People Where They Are

Coordinate Emergency Shelter/Transport to Detox

Offer Tangible Street Survival Items

Provide Pathway To Permanent Housing



**Partners Ending
Homelessness**

Rochester, New York's

Continuum of Care (CoC)

Tree Clemonds

Executive Director



**Partners Ending
Homelessness**

Rochester, New York's

Continuum of Care

- **What Is The CoC**
- **What is the Prioritization List/Coordinated Entry**
- **What Is A PIT (Point In Time)Count?**
- **Policy/Advocacy/Saving Hud Funding**
- **Code Blue**

**HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS: ADDRESSING THE CRISIS IN
ROCHESTER AND BEYOND**



**Number of People on Coordinated Entry
Right Now?**

**How Many People Did the CoC Get Housed in
Monroe County in 2024-
YTD 2025-**



Statistics

2024 PIT Count (Point In Time)



NY-500: Rochester, Irondequoit, Greece/Monroe County CoC.
(2024, January 25). *PIT Summary Report: Sheltered and Unsheltered Count*. Retrieved from [<https://letsendhomelessness.org/reports/>].

Monroe County, New York



2025 PIT Count (Point In Time)



138 Persons or a 13.7% Increase of Unhoused Persons from 2024

NY-500: Rochester, Irondequoit, Greece/Monroe County CoC.
(2024, January 25). *PIT Summary Report: Sheltered and Unsheltered Count*. Retrieved from [<https://letsendhomelessness.org/reports/>].

Monroe County, New York

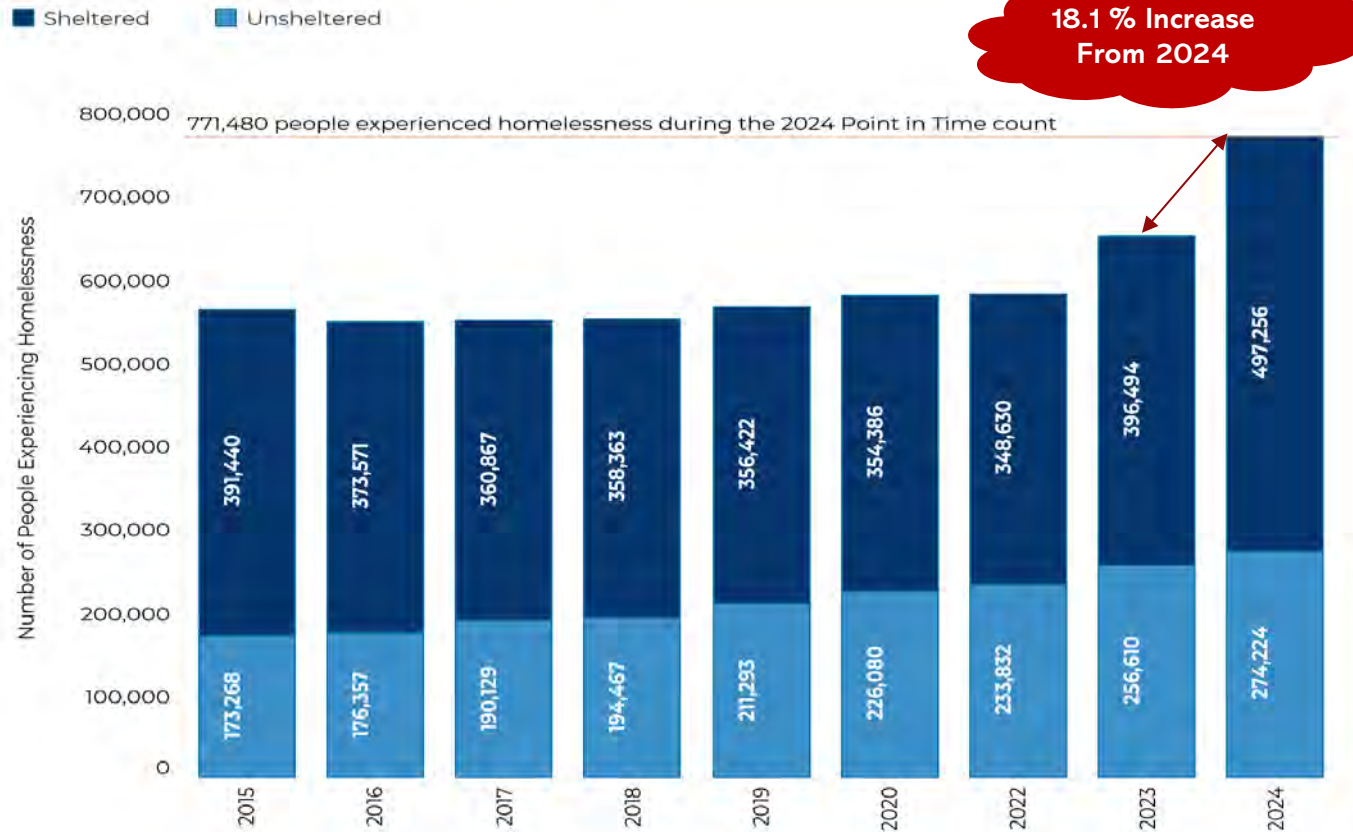


Increase in Homelessness Over Time

Source: <https://endhomelessness.org/resources/toolkits-and-training-materials/2025-homelessness-data-dashboards/state-pit-counts/>

New York State

Increase in Homelessness Over Time



Source: U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development, 2024 AHAR: Part 1 Point-in-Time Estimates (Accessed December 2024), <https://www.huduser.gov/portal/datasets/ahar/2024-ahar-part-1-pit-estimates-of-homelessness-in-the-us.html>.

Note: 2021 is not included due to interruptions in data collection caused by the COVID-19 pandemic.

Nationally



City of Rochester, NY

Carol Wheeler

Manager of Housing

Department of Neighborhood and Business Development



CITY OF ROCHESTER, NY

**WHAT IS THE CITY OF ROCHESTER'S
ROLE IN SOLVING ROCHESTER'S
HOMELESSNESS CRISIS?**

- **THE NEED FOR AFFORDABLE
HOUSING**
- **CURRENT PROJECTS**
- **FUTURE HOUSING PLANS**



City of Rochester, NY

Alia-Henton-Williams

Manager

Crisis Intervention Services Unit Homicide Response Team (HRT)

Person In Crisis Team (PIC)

Community Support Team



CITY OF ROCHESTER, NY

**WHAT ROLE DO THESE TEAMS PLAY IN
HELPING PEOPLE IN CRISIS AND IN
REDUCING HOMELESSNESS?**

- CRISIS INTERVENTION SERVICES UNIT (CIT)
- HOMICIDE RESPONSE TEAM (HRT)
- PERSON IN CRISIS TEAM (PIC)
- COMMUNITY SUPPORT TEAM (CST)



EMERGENCY HOMELESS SHELTER

KIMBERLY BUYERS, LMSW

Director of Social Work and Outreach

House of Mercy Emergency Homeless Shelter

Rochester, NY



WHAT ROLE DOES HOUSE OF MERCY PLAY IN REDUCING HOMELESSNESS

- TEMPORARY SHELTER
- HOMELESS OUTREACH
- CASE MANAGEMENT
- ASSISTANCE WITH PERMANENT HOUSING
- NUMBER OF BEDS
- WARMING CENTER
- # OF PEOPLE SHELTERED PER YEAR

EMERGENCY SHELTER & OUTREACH



AMY D'AMICO, ESQ.

ATTORNEY

ADVOCATE FOR THE UNHOUSED

HOMELESS OUTREACH VOLUNTEER

GRANTS PASS RESISTANCE

LIVED EXPERIENCE

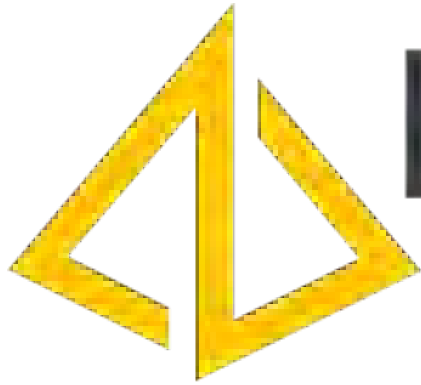
Advocacy

HOW DOES AMY'S ADVOCACY HELP THE UNHOUSED

- **Advocate for the Unhoused**
(Outreach and Engagement, Helping the Unhoused Store Their Belongings during Encampment Sweeps, Referral's to Local Agencies)
- **Advocate for the End of Encampment Sweeps**
- **Advocate for Policy Change/Grants Pass**



AMY D'AMICO, ESQ-ADVOCATE FOR THE UNHOUSED



LIBERTY
RESOURCES

Safe Options Support (SOS)

Lisa Nichols, MS, ED, CRPA

Team Leader

Safe Options Support (SOS)



**What Role Does
Liberty
Resources Play
In**

**Reducing
Homelessness?**

**Street Outreach
Behavioral Health**

**Assistance With
Permanent Housing**



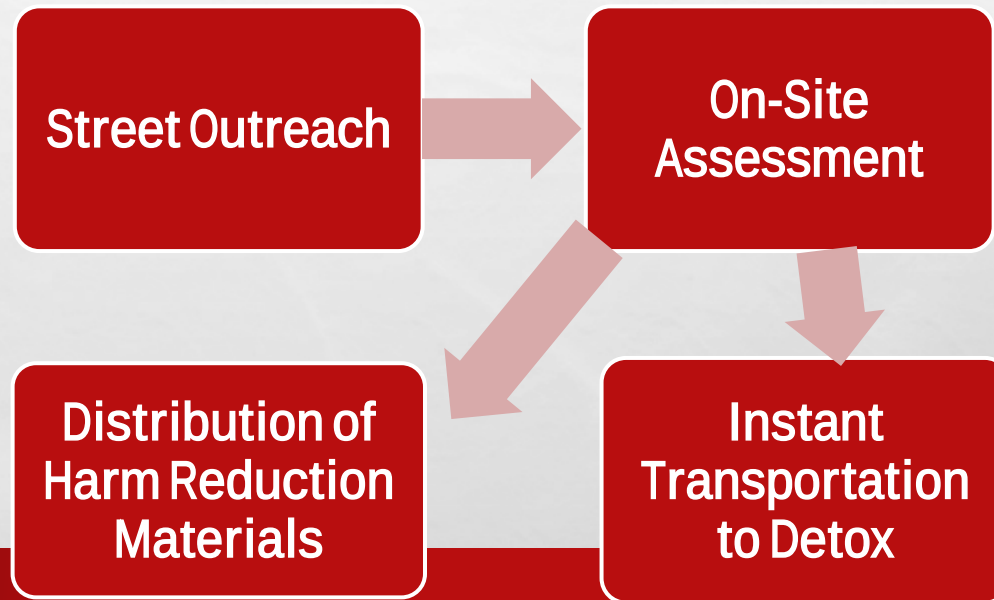
Paige Caisey, BS, Advanced CASAC

Monroe County Street Outreach Team Leader



Monroe County Street Outreach Team

What Role Does The Helio Street Outreach Team Play in Saving The Live's of the Unhoused Suffering From Substance Abuse Addiction?





What Can Planners, Municipalities and Community Development Professionals Do?

- **Include The Unhoused In Urban and Regional Planning**
- **Create More Affordable/Creative Housing/Tiny Home Villages**
- **Adaptive Re-Use (Vacant Buildings/Motels)**
- **Activate Other Unused/Underutilized Spaces**
- **Advocate For Housing-First Models**
- **Push Zoning & Policy Changes For Inclusivity of the Unhoused**
- **Agency/Stakeholder Collaboration**

CALL TO ACTION FOR ROCHESTER'S CD PRO'S

What Can Planners, Municipalities and Community Development Professionals Do?

- **Can the County and State Allocate Designated Land for Camping?**

Include Portable Toilets, Garbage Pick-up, Needle Clean-up, Daily Rotating Agency visits Including: Street Medicine Workers, Outreach Workers, Social Workers, the Faith Community and Other Community Agency's Providing Food, and Other Personal Needs Items, While the Residents Wait to Move into Permanent Housing

CALL TO ACTION FOR ROCHESTER'S CD PRO'S

What Can You Do

Don't Judge

Please Understand That:

- **No One Chooses To Be Homeless**
- **There Are A Myriad Of Reasons People Become Homeless**
- **Not Everyone Who Is Homeless Is A Drug Addict Or Has MH Issues**
- **There Is A Severe Shortage Of Affordable Housing, Esp. Since COVID**
- **Keep Water Bottles And Soft Granola Bars/Snacks In Your Car For
When You Encounter An Unhoused Individual Or A Panhandler**
- **Treat Everyone With Compassion**

CALL TO ACTION FOR ROCHESTER RESIDENTS



Help Us End Homelessness!

HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS: Addressing The Crisis In Rochester And Beyond

QUESTION AND ANSWER SESSION

Collaboration Is Key

QUESTION AND ANSWER SESSION

ROCHESTER'S DEDICATED AND PASSIONATE HOMELESS ECOSYSTEM PANEL AND THEIR ROLES

- **NICK COULTER** — FOUNDED PARTNER, VP OF DEVELOPMENT, PERSON CENTERED HOUSING OPTIONS, INC. (PCHO)
- **STEPHEN ROSA** — SENIOR OUTREACH AND ENGAGEMENT SPECIALIST (PCHO)
- **TREE CLEMONDS** — EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR — PARTNERS ENDING HOMELESSNESS/LOCAL CONTINUUM OF CARE
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- **LISA NICHOLS** — MS. ED. CRPA, , TEAM LEADER, LIBERTY RESOURCES SAFE OPTIONS SUPPORT (SOS)
- **PAIGE CASEY** — BS, ADVANCED CASAC, STREET OUTREACH TEAM LEADER, -HELIO HEALTH IN MONROE COUNTY



THANK YOU!

RACHEL S. BAILEY, MUP

HOMELESS OUTREACH PROGRAM MANAGER

PERSON CENTERED HOUSING OPTIONS, INC.

PROGRAM MANAGER

TEMPO EMERGENCY SHELTER HOMES

585-645-7548

RBAILEY@PCHO.ORG

ROOTZY36@GMAIL.COM



HOMELESSNESS IN FOCUS: ADDRESSING THE CRISIS IN
ROCHESTER AND BEYOND